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I Love My Baby. I Miss Myself.

A gentle reset for the new mom who lost
herself in the love.

You'd give her the world. You also barely recognize yourself.

You love your baby more than your own breath. And some days you sit there, milk-stained and bone-tired, and think: *where did I go?* Both of those things are true at once. You are not a bad mom for feeling it.

This isn't about "bouncing back" — that woman doesn't need to come back, because she grew into someone new. This is about coming back to *yourself*, gently, in the small spaces you actually have.

A NOTE FIRST

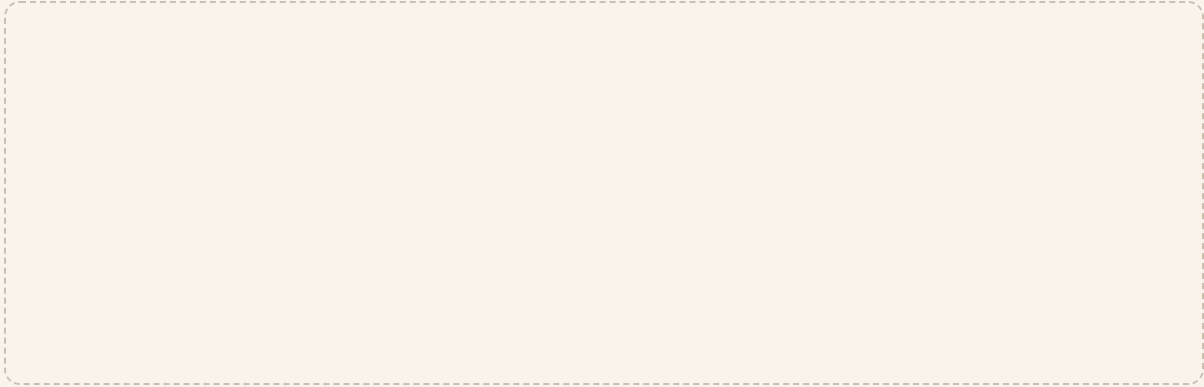
Loving your child and missing your old life are not opposites. You're allowed to hold both without guilt. Let's make a little room for you.

STEP 1

Name what you miss

You can't make room for what you won't name. Grieving parts of your old life doesn't mean you regret your baby. Write it honestly:

What I miss about who I was:



Maybe it's your body, your friendships, quiet mornings, your name (not just "Mom"), or simply feeling like yourself. All of it is valid. Naming it is the first step home.

STEP 2

The 10-minute you

You don't need a spa day or a babysitter. You need 10 minutes that are *yours* — tiny deposits back into you. Pick a few:

- A hot drink, sitting down, while it's still hot.
- One song that was yours before you were "Mom." Loud.
- A short walk — stroller counts — just to feel the air.
- Text one friend like the woman you were, not just the mom you are.
- Five minutes of a thing you love: a book, a sketch, a show, the sun.

My 10 minutes today will be:

STEP 3

Ask for help without the guilt

Needing help doesn't make you less of a mother. It makes you a human one. Use the words:

“ I need an hour to myself this weekend. Can you take the baby?

“ Can you own bath and bedtime tonight — fully, so I can rest?

“ When you ask "what can I do," the answer is: take something off my list without me directing it.

“ I'm not okay today and I need backup. That's not me failing — that's me asking.

THE MENTAL LOAD

"Help" still leaves you managing. Hand over whole jobs to own — not tasks to be reminded of.

STEP 4

The lies new-motherhood tells you

That guilty voice is loud and wrong. Trade each lie for the truth:

THE LIE

"A good mom loves every minute."

THE TRUTH

Good moms have hard, lonely, bored minutes. Loving her doesn't mean loving every second.

THE LIE

"Needing time away means I'm selfish."

THE TRUTH

A refilled mom has more to give. Time for you *is* for her too.

THE LIE

"Everyone else has it together."

THE TRUTH

They don't. They're just not posting the 3 a.m. tears.

You're still in there.

Say them softly. They're true:

- I can love my baby and still miss my old life.
- I don't have to disappear to be a good mother.
- Taking care of me is part of taking care of her.
- I am becoming, not broken.
- The woman I was is still in here — and she's allowed to take up space.

Please hear this: if you feel persistently sad, numb, hopeless, anxious, or like you can't cope — that may be postpartum depression or anxiety, and it is common and very treatable. Please reach out to your doctor or midwife. You deserve support, and asking for it is strength.

You didn't lose her. She's just holding a baby.

Ten minutes at a time, you come back to yourself. Loving her and keeping you were never a choice. You get to be a whole person and a wonderful mom — both, at once.

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